WEB TRACKING & PRIVACY

Comparing consent choices and browser ad blockers

Public report | Kruidvat.nl | Four controlled browser visits

Scope and collection method

Four separate browser sessions on kruidvat.nl were captured as HTTP Archive (HAR) files. The same shopping workflow was followed under four configurations: accepting optional consent, rejecting optional consent, accepting with uBlock Origin Lite, and accepting with AdGuard AdBlocker.

Aggregate results

Metric	Accept	Reject	uBlock	AdGuard
HTTP requests	529	388	239	441
Third-party domains	33	12	4	16
Third-party entities	27	6	1	12
Cross-domain redirects	17	0	0	6
Server IP addresses	49	20	10	30
Potential tracking cookies	103	59	49	72

Findings

The reject session contacted 12 third-party domains, compared with 33 in the accept session. Rejecting optional consent reduced the observed third-party contact but did not eliminate it.

uBlock Origin Lite had the lowest observed counts for HTTP requests (239), third-party domains (4), and mapped third-party entities (1). AdGuard had higher counts in this capture (441, 16, and 12 respectively).

Example third-party entity

Contentsquare appeared among the mapped third-party entities. It provides digital experience analytics, including tools to study how visitors interact with websites.

https://contentsquare.com/

Interpretation and limitations

These results describe four individual visits, not repeated trials or a general ranking of ad blockers. Website changes, timing, and network behavior may affect the counts. A cookie with SameSite=None is only a potential tracking indicator; the attribute alone does not establish that tracking took place.

Source: local HAR captures; aggregate counts published in results/summary.json.

Raw HAR files, cookie values, IP addresses, and student identifiers are excluded.

COMPARATIVE METRICS

Observed counts across the four browser configurations

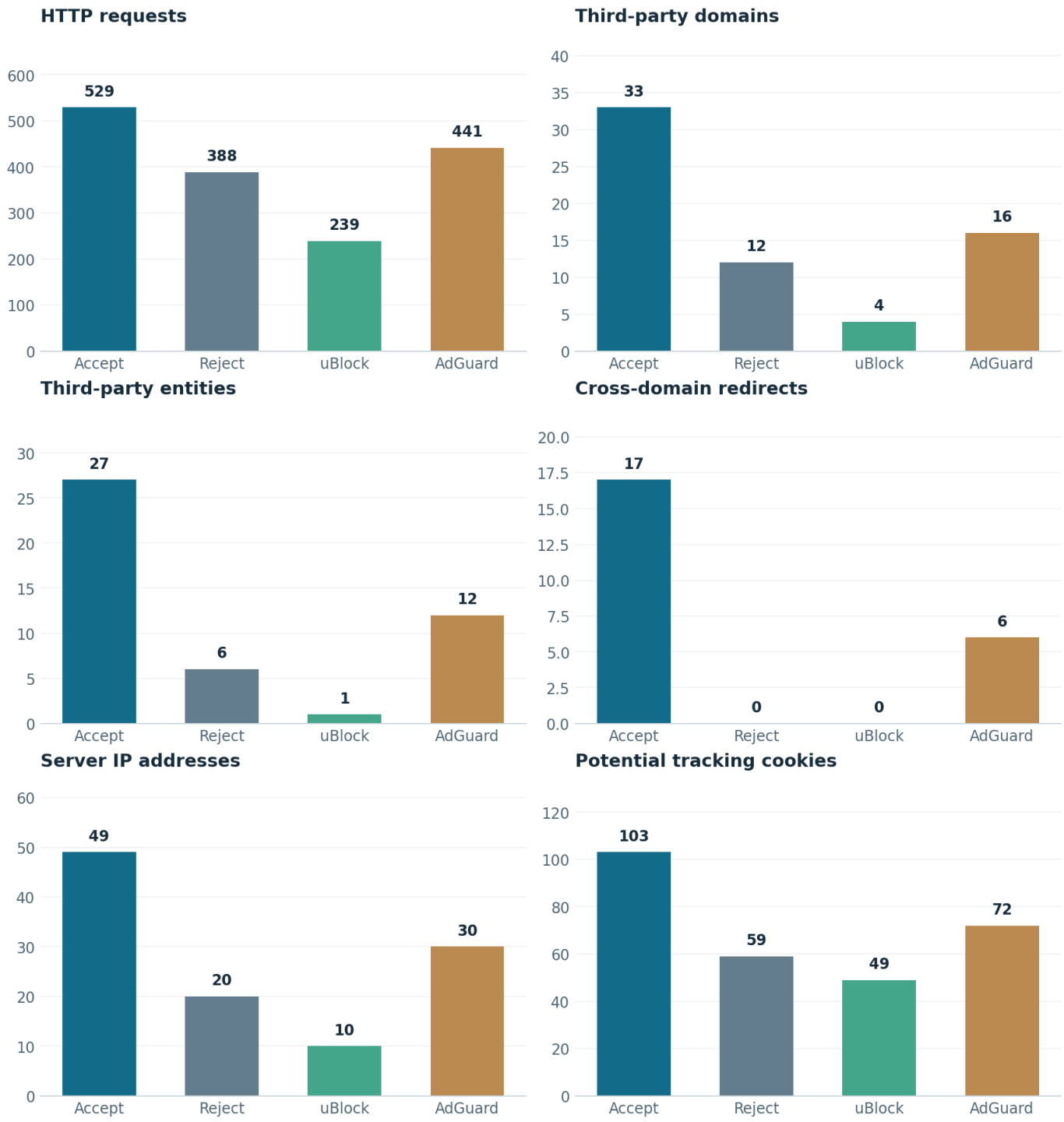


Figure 1. Distinct-domain and entity metrics use registrable domains (eTLD+1).

Potential tracking cookies are Set-Cookie records with SameSite=None.

These charts reproduce the aggregate results from the original project.